

Going Home After Cherry Eye Surgery

Post-operative care guide for your dog

Your dog had a cherry eye repair at the shelter to reposition the prolapsed third eyelid gland back to its normal location. Refer to your discharge paperwork for specific medications and follow-up instructions.

What to Expect

- Cherry eye is a prolapsed third eyelid gland. Your dog's surgery used the pocket technique, which repositions the gland back into place without removing it.
- Mild swelling, redness, and discharge are normal for the first 24–48 hours.
- Swelling should gradually improve over the following 1–2 weeks.

Home Care

- Apply eye drops or ointment exactly as directed — do not skip doses.
- The e-collar must stay on at all times when your dog is unsupervised.
- Do not allow swimming or getting water in the eye during recovery.
- No off-leash activity or rough play until your veterinarian gives the all-clear.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Dog Has:

- The gland appears to be coming out again
- Increasing swelling, redness, or discharge after the first 48 hours
- Squinting, keeping the eye closed, or signs of pain
- Thick yellow or green discharge from the eye
- Rubbing the eye despite wearing the e-collar

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **10–14 days** after surgery, as directed in your discharge paperwork.

If you have any concerns before your scheduled visit, do not wait — call your veterinary clinic.